THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 04

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) At the current rate of demand, India's coal reserves are estimated to last roughly —

(A) 50 more years (B) 15 more years (C) 150 more years (D) 500 more years

> **Ans: (A)** Hence coal must be used judiciously until sustainable options spread.

(ii) The Bhadla Solar Park, a symbol of India's solar ambitions, is located in the state of —

(A) Gujarat (B) Karnataka (C) Rajasthan (D) Tamil Nadu

> **Ans: (C)** Bhadla is a large solar park in Rajasthan.

(iii) Who composed the Telugu epic Amuktamalyada?

(A) Harihara (B) Bukka (C) Ramaraya (D) Krishnadevaraya

> **Ans: (D)** He composed it on the Tamil poet-saint Andal; its Rajaniti section explains his ideas of governance.

(iv) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Rani Durgavati's last battle
2. Battle of Haldighati
3. Second Battle of Panipat
4. Battle of Talikota

(A) 1, 3, 4, 2 (B) 3, 4, 1, 2 (C) 3, 1, 4, 2 (D) 3, 1, 2, 4

> **Ans: (C)** Correct order: Second Battle of Panipat (1556) → Rani Durgavati's last battle (1564) → Battle of Talikota (1565) → Battle of Haldighati (1576)

(v) Who first compiled the Guru Granth Sahib?

(A) Guru Nanak (B) Guru Arjan
(C) Guru Hargobind (D) Guru Gobind Singh

> **Ans: (B)** Hymns of Guru Tegh Bahadur were added later.

(vi) In which year did the Marathas suffer a disastrous defeat against the Afghans at Panipat?

(A) 1761 (B) 1526 (C) 1556 (D) 1771

> **Ans: (A)** They recovered under Peshwa Madhavrao I.

(vii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.

Assertion (A): Shivaji's creation of a navy was a revolutionary step for its time.
Reason (R): The Bijapur Sultanate and even the Mughals did not have a full-time naval force.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R shows why the step was revolutionary.

(viii) Who wrote 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' (1901), compiling from British reports the wealth drained out of India?

(A) Dadabhai Naoroji (B) Romesh Chunder Dutt
(C) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay (D) Charles Wilkins

> **Ans: (A)** R.C. Dutt wrote the Economic History of India.

(ix) The Indigo Revolt (1859–62) was directed mainly against —

(A) Moneylenders in Chota Nagpur (B) European planters
(C) The Portuguese in Goa (D) Mughal officials

> **Ans: (B)** Planters forced peasants of northern Bengal to grow indigo instead of food crops.

(x) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi captured the fort of Gwalior during the Rebellion of 1857.
Statement II: Nana Saheb led the rebel forces at Lucknow.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Nana Saheb led the rebels at Kanpur; Begum Hazrat Mahal led the defence of Lucknow.

(xi) Before Independence, what share of Indians were eligible to vote?

(A) About 5 per cent (B) About 33 per cent
(C) About 13 per cent (D) About 50 per cent

> **Ans: (C)** Universal adult franchise made every citizen aged 18+ an equal voter.

(xii) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.
The ..... century Uttaramerur inscriptions describe a transparent method of selecting representatives, using names drawn from a pot.

(A) 5th (B) 15th (C) 18th (D) 10th

> **Ans: (D)** Names were written on palm leaves and drawn at random.

(xiii) The Sengol, a symbol of just rule, is placed in the Parliament building near the —

(A) President's seat (B) Entrance gate
(C) Speaker's chair (D) Prime Minister's office

> **Ans: (C)** It was handed to Nehru on 14 August 1947; the Nandi on top symbolises justice.

(xiv) The nominal head of the Union Executive in India is the —

(A) President (B) Prime Minister (C) Speaker (D) Chief Justice

> **Ans: (A)** The Prime Minister is the de facto executive authority.

(xv) In which year did J.R.D. Tata start Tata Airlines, which later became Air India?

(A) 1912 (B) 1947 (C) 1992 (D) 1932

> **Ans: (D)** J.R.D. Tata was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 1992.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Why is coal called a non-renewable resource? What should be done about its use?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - It is created over very long periods and cannot be replenished at the rate we use it — 1 mark
> - It must be used judiciously/sparingly until sustainable alternatives become widespread — 1 mark

O R

2.(B) What is meant by 'human capital'? How is it different from labour?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Human capital — the knowledge, skills and expertise that make labour efficient — 1 mark
- Labour is the basic physical/mental effort; human capital is the quality of that labour — 1 mark

3. Who were Harihara and Bukka? Where, according to folklore, did they build their capital?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Two brothers who had served as governors under Muhammad bin Tughlaq and rejected Delhi's authority; founded the Vijayanagara Empire — 1 mark
- Capital at Hampi, on advice of their guru Vidyaranya, after seeing a hare chasing hounds — 1 mark

4.(A) Why did the British call the events of 1857 the 'Sepoy Mutiny'? What do historians call it now?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Sepoys were Indian soldiers of the Company's army; the British treated the event as a mere revolt of soldiers — 1 mark
- Historians now call it the Great Rebellion of 1857 — 1 mark

O R

4.(B) Mention any two causes of the Indigo Revolt.

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- European planters forced peasants to grow indigo instead of food crops
- Peasants were paid so poorly that they fell into debt
- Those who refused faced imprisonment, torture and destruction of property (any two, 1 mark each)

5. Mention any two measures of the Election Commission to help persons with disabilities to vote.

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- Home voting for the elderly and disabled (2024)
- Braille-enabled voter cards
- App-based requests for assistance
- Wheelchairs and ramps at polling stations (any two, 1 mark each)

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three achievements of Krishnadevaraya.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Brought the Vijayanagara Empire to its peak and secured dominance over the Deccan
- Patronised poets and scholars of Sanskrit, Telugu and Kannada
- Composed Amuktamalyada; its Rajaniti section explains good governance
- Gave grants to temples at Tirupati and the Vitthala temple (musical pillars)
- Treated Portuguese traders well because they sold horses

O R

6.(B) Write any three features of the Hoysala kingdom.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Ruled parts of present-day Karnataka; fended off several attacks and for a time was the only independent kingdom in the south
- Built magnificent temples at Belur and Halebidu
- Emblem from the story of Sala who fought a lion — 'Hoy (strike)! Sala'
- Weakened by attacks and internal conflict, was absorbed into the Vijayanagara Empire in the mid-14th century

7.(A) Explain any three reasons for the decline of Maratha power.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Disastrous defeat at Panipat (1761)
- Growing internal disunity; regional chiefs became autonomous, leading to indiscipline and abuses
- Superior organisation and technology of the British
- Three Anglo-Maratha Wars (1775–1818)

O R

7.(B) Describe any three features of the culture of the Thanjavur Marathas under Serfoji II.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Wrote the Marathi play Devendra Kuravanji describing world geography; knew many Indian and European languages
- Patronised musicians — modern Carnatic music took shape; early Bharatanatyam
- Founded the Dhanwantari Mahal — free treatment with Indian and Western medicine
- Started a printing press, the first by a native ruler; inscribed the Bhonsle history on the Brihadishwara temple walls

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Trace the rise of the Sikhs from Guru Nanak to Guru Gobind Singh in five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Guru Nanak (15th-century Punjab) preached equality, compassion and one God (Ik Onkar)
- Jahangir had Guru Arjan tortured to death; Guru Arjan compiled the Guru Granth Sahib
- Guru Hargobind introduced martial training and formed a Sikh army
- Guru Tegh Bahadur accepted martyrdom in 1675 (Chandni Chowk) defending the Kashmir Pandits
- Guru Gobind Singh established the Khalsa in 1699
- Maharaja Ranjit Singh later united Sikh confederacies into the Sikh Empire

O R

8.(B) Explain any five features of the Mughal administration under Akbar.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Empire divided into twelve provinces (subahs); checks and balances between officials
- Diwan — finance; Mir Bakhshi — military; Khan-i-Saman — household and public works; Sadr — justice and religion
- Mansabdari system — officers graded by rank and maintaining troops, horses and elephants
- Mansabdars paid by jagirs (land assignments)
- Todar Mal's revenue reforms — surveys of land, crop yields and prices
- Village self-governance continued undisturbed

9. Explain the four factors of production and the role of technology, with one example for each.

Marking points (1 mark each):

- Land (natural resources) — soil, water, minerals, forests; e.g. site of a factory
- Labour — physical and mental effort of workers; e.g. farmers, teachers
- Capital — money and durable assets like machines, tools, vehicles; e.g. a tractor
- Entrepreneurship — identifying a problem, taking risk and combining factors; e.g. starting a restaurant
- Technology as facilitator — application of scientific knowledge; e.g. UPI, drones in farming

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Fossil-fuel industrialisation and the clearing of forests have raised the temperature of the Earth. The glaciers of the Himalayas, which feed the great rivers of the plains and are sometimes called the region's 'water tower', now melt faster than snowfall can replace them. If this continues, the rivers that sustain farms and cities may eventually lose their dependable source of water.

(10.1) Name any one human activity that has raised the Earth's temperature.

> Burning of fossil fuels / industrialisation / deforestation.

(10.2) What is happening to the glaciers of the Himalayas?

> They are melting faster than they are replaced by snowfall.

(10.3) How may this affect the people living in the plains? Give two points.

> Any two (1 mark each): rivers may lose their dependable water supply; drinking water and irrigation for farms and cities threatened; floods in the short run and scarcity later.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Krishnadevaraya (16th century) took the Vijayanagara Empire to its peak. A scholar himself, he composed the Telugu epic Amuktamalyada, on the Tamil poet-saint Andal. One section of it, the Rajaniti, sets out his ideas on good governance. He gave generous grants to temples, including those at Tirupati and the Vitthala temple at Vijayanagara, famous for its musical pillars.

(11.1) Which Telugu epic did Krishnadevaraya compose?

> Amuktamalyada.

(11.2) About whom is the epic written?

> The Tamil poet-saint Andal.

(11.3) How did Krishnadevaraya support culture and religion? Give two points.

> Any two (1 mark each): patronised poets/scholars of Sanskrit, Telugu and Kannada; composed a literary work himself; gave grants to temples at Tirupati and the Vitthala temple.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The Santhals of present-day Jharkhand, Bihar and West Bengal rose in rebellion in 1855–56 under the brothers Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu. Moneylenders and landlords, backed by the British, were taking away their ancestral lands. The Santhals declared their own government and vowed to 'fight to the last drop of blood'. The British burned entire villages and killed thousands, including the rebel leaders.

(12.1) Who led the Santhal Rebellion?

> Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu.

(12.2) Against whom did the Santhals rebel?

> Moneylenders and landlords (supported by the British).

(12.3) Explain the importance of the Santhal Rebellion in India's resistance to colonial rule.

> (1) It showed tribal communities' resolve to defend land and self-rule; (1) it inspired other tribal communities to resist despite harsh British repression.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Parliament meets in three sessions a year — the Budget, Monsoon and Winter sessions — and usually sits for about six hours each day. Yet its working has been disturbed by absenteeism and disruptions of Question Hour. Productivity of the Rajya Sabha fell from 78 per cent (2004–14) to about 65 per cent after that, and touched a low of 35.75 per cent in 2018.

(13.1) Name the three sessions of Parliament held every year.

> Budget, Monsoon and Winter sessions.

(13.2) What was the lowest productivity of the Rajya Sabha mentioned, and in which year?

> 35.75 per cent, in 2018.

(13.3) Suggest any two ways of improving the functioning of the legislatures.

> Any two (1 mark each): an informed citizenry; public debate; digital engagement; youth participation; regular attendance and cooperative conduct by members.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Belur (Hoysala temples)
(II) Anandpur Sahib
(III) Sindhudurg Fort
(IV) Plassey (Palashi)
(V) Bhadla Solar Park
(VI) Keonjhar iron ore mine

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Belur located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Anandpur Sahib located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sindhudurg Fort located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Plassey located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bhadla Solar Park located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Keonjhar iron ore mine located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Belur (Hoysala temples) — **Karnataka**
- (II) Anandpur Sahib — **Punjab**
- (III) Sindhudurg Fort — **Maharashtra**
- (IV) Plassey (Palashi) — **West Bengal**
- (V) Bhadla Solar Park — **Rajasthan**
- (VI) Keonjhar iron ore mine — **Odisha**

